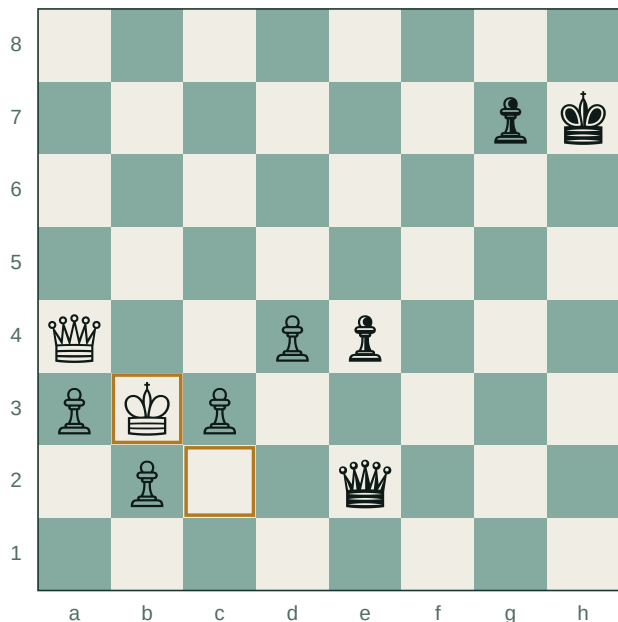


Queen-ending tactics: Black, move 40

Queen-ending tactics

Black to move



Previous move: 40.Kb3. Gold borders mark its start and finish.

WORKED CONTINUATION - COVER THIS SECTION FIRST

40...Qd1+ 41. Kb4 Qxa4+ 42. Kxa4 e3

40...Qd1+ Check restricts White to 3 legal replies here. Recorded reply: **41.Kb4**.

41...Qxa4+ Check restricts White to 2 legal replies here. The move also takes the queen on a4. Recorded reply: **42.Kxa4**.

42...e3 The pawn moves from e4 to e3.

At the end, nominal material is White 4 / Black 2 (P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9). Over this line, Black's balance changes by +0. Activity and king safety still affect the evaluation.

CHECKPOINT

Using P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9, how much does Black's material balance change over the complete line? **Answer:** +0: the balance goes from -2 to -2. Count promotions and every recapture, not just the first gain.

CARRY THE IDEA INTO YOUR GAMES

A favorable-looking queen exchange can lead to a drawn pawn ending. Evaluate the new ending before simplifying.

WHAT THIS POSITION TEACHES

Queens combine long-range checks with promotion support. King shelter and the order of checks often matter more than a small material lead.

HOW TO LOOK

Inspect perpetual-check possibilities, queen trades, and checks that gain a tempo for a passed pawn.

The defending king is on b3. Look for a defender that can be displaced or overloaded.